

Please, advise about how to use Tableau public for data analytics especially visualization phase. Provide me with a open public dataset from kaggle which I can load externally officially and work using various aspects like color, size, etc to create an impactful viz. Also narrate me steps how to share my work with others that is how can I make my viz public accessible and tell me how can I have interactive dashboard.

Absolutely. **Tableau Public is an excellent way to learn the complete analytics-to-visualization workflow**, because you can go from a raw dataset → analysis → interactive dashboard → publicly accessible portfolio project.

I would recommend that you learn it as a **storytelling tool**, rather than simply learning how to make charts.

1. A good dataset to start with

I recommend the **Global Superstore** dataset on Kaggle.

Kaggle has a public version containing roughly **51,290 order records and 24 columns**, including orders, customers/products, sales, profit, regions, categories, shipping information and returns. [k Kaggle](#)

Global Superstore dataset on Kaggle

This is particularly good for learning Tableau because it gives you many dimensions and measures to experiment with:

Type	Examples
Dimensions	Country, Region, State, City
Product	Category, Sub-Category, Product Name
Customer	Customer Name, Segment
Time	Order Date, Ship Date
Measures	Sales, Profit, Quantity, Discount
Geography	Country, State, City
Shipping	Ship Mode

Type	Examples
Other	Order ID, Returned

The dataset is also large enough to make your visualizations interesting without being overwhelmingly complicated.

Important: before using a Kaggle dataset in a public portfolio, check the dataset's stated license/usage terms. The Kaggle page currently identifies the license as "Other (specified in description)." [k](#) Kaggle

2. What I recommend you build

Don't start by making 15 random charts.

Instead, imagine that you are a **Business/Data Analyst hired by a retail company**.

Your business question could be:

"What is driving sales and profitability, and where should management focus its attention?"

Then build a dashboard that answers that question.

Your final dashboard could look conceptually like this:

GLOBAL SUPERSTORE PERFORMANCE			
Sales	Profit	Orders	Profit Margin
\$XXX	\$XXX	XXXX	XX.X%
Sales & Profit Trend			
Sales by Category		Profit by Region	
Technology	████████	West	████████
Furniture	██████	East	██████
Office	████	Central	██
Geographic Performance Map			
Filters: Year Region Category Segment Ship Mode			

That's much more valuable for your portfolio than simply showing "here is a pie chart."

3. Learn Tableau through the visual encoding system

This is probably the **most important Tableau concept** for you.

Tableau lets you encode information using properties such as:

- **Position**
- **Color**
- **Size**
- **Shape**
- **Label**
- **Detail**
- **Tooltip**

Think about them as different ways of communicating information.

Example

Suppose you create a scatter plot:

X-axis: Sales

Y-axis: Profit

Then:

Color → Category

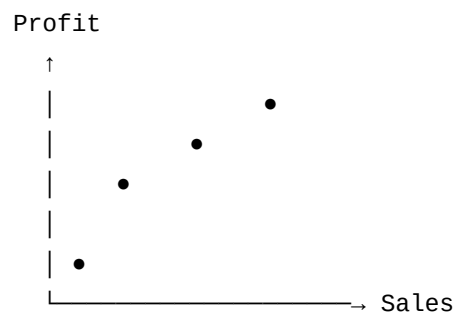
Size → Sales

Shape → Segment

Label → Product/Region

You have suddenly created a multidimensional visualization.

For example:



Color = Category

Size = Sales

Shape = Segment

That's where Tableau becomes powerful.

4. Your first Tableau exercise

Once you download the dataset, start with a simple worksheet.

Sheet 1 — Sales vs Profit

Drag:

Columns

→ Sales

Rows

→ Profit

Then change the Marks type to:

→ **Circle**

Now experiment.

Color

Drag:

Category

onto **Color**.

Now each category has a different color.

Size

Drag:

Sales

onto **Size**.

Now large-sales observations become larger circles.

Detail

Drag:

State

onto **Detail**.

Now Tableau knows that each state should be represented individually.

Tooltip

Drag:

Profit

or other useful fields onto Tooltip.

Hovering over a mark will now reveal information.

This teaches you five fundamental Tableau concepts almost immediately.

5. Then learn these visualization types

I would learn them in approximately this order.

Level 1 — Basic

Bar chart

Use for:

Which category has the highest sales?

Line chart

Use for:

How are sales changing over time?

Map

Use for:

Where are sales/profits coming from?

Level 2 — Analytical

Scatter plot

Use for:

Is there a relationship between sales and profit?

This is particularly important because it can reveal something interesting:

High Sales + High Profit	→ ★ Good
High Sales + Low Profit	→ ⚠ Investigate
Low Sales + High Profit	→ Interesting
Low Sales + Low Profit	→ ✖ Weak

That is much more analytical than simply saying "Technology has the highest sales."

Level 3 — Advanced

Learn:

- Heatmaps
- Highlight tables
- Treemaps
- Dual-axis charts
- Parameters
- Calculated fields
- Sets
- Reference lines
- Trend lines
- Filters
- Dashboard actions
- Tooltips
- Maps
- Story points

You don't need to master all of these immediately.

6. Calculated fields — where analytics really begins

Don't rely only on fields supplied by the dataset.

Create your own metrics.

For example:

Profit Margin

Create:

```
Profit Margin =  
SUM([Profit]) / SUM([Sales])
```

Format it as a percentage.

Now you can answer:

"Which products generate sales?"

and also:

"Which products generate profitable sales?"

Those are very different questions.

You can also create:

Average Order Value

```
SUM([Sales]) / COUNTD([Order ID])
```

And perhaps:

Discount Impact

You can investigate the relationship between:

```
Discount → Sales → Profit
```

This is where your project starts looking like genuine data analytics rather than a Tableau tutorial.

7. Color — don't just make things "pretty"

A common beginner mistake is:

"I'll use lots of colors because Tableau allows me to."

Don't.

Use color to communicate meaning.

For example:

Category

Technology
Furniture
Office Supplies

Using consistent categorical colors makes sense.

But for **Profit**, use a diverging color scheme:

Loss ← 0 → Profit

You can use:

- red → loss
- neutral → around zero
- green → profit

The important principle is:

Color should answer a question, not decorate the dashboard.

8. Size — another very powerful encoding

Suppose you have a map.

You could use:

Color → Profit

Size → Sales

Then:

Large circle + green = high sales and high profit

while:

Large circle + red = high sales but poor profitability

That second type of location could be particularly interesting to management.

This is an example of how **two visual encodings can reveal a business insight simultaneously**.

9. Build an interactive dashboard

Once you've created several worksheets, create a **Dashboard**.

Tableau allows you to combine worksheets into a dashboard and add interactions between them.  [Tableau Help](#)

For example, create:

Sheet 1

KPI cards

- Total Sales
- Total Profit
- Orders
- Profit Margin

Sheet 2

Sales Trend

Sheet 3

Category Performance

Sheet 4

Regional Performance

Sheet 5

Map

Then put them onto a dashboard.

10. Make the dashboard interactive

This is one of the most important things I recommend you learn.

Suppose you have:

Category
Technology
Furniture
Office Supplies

Clicking **Technology** should cause your other charts to update.

For example:

Category Chart

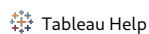


Technology



Sales Trend	→ filtered
Map	→ filtered
Products	→ filtered
Profit	→ filtered

In Tableau, you can select a sheet and use **"Use as Filter"** so selections in that visualization filter the other dashboard views. Tableau also supports more advanced dashboard actions.



Example interaction

Click:

West

The entire dashboard changes to:

West region only

Click:

Technology

Now:

West + Technology

This makes the dashboard feel like an analytical application rather than a static report.

11. Add filters

Put these filters on your dashboard:

Year
Region
Category
Sub-Category
Segment
Ship Mode

Now your user can ask:

"Show me Technology sales in the West during 2025."

without you creating another chart.

This is one of the major advantages of an interactive dashboard.

12. Go one step further — create a parameter

Parameters are particularly good for portfolio projects.

For example:

"Select Metric"

Allow the user to choose:

Sales
Profit
Quantity
Profit Margin

Then the visualization dynamically changes according to the selection.

Your dashboard becomes:

"Choose what you want to analyze."

This is a great skill to demonstrate in a Tableau portfolio.

13. Tooltips are underrated

Don't simply show:

State
Sales
Profit

Create a useful tooltip.

For example:

California

Sales: \$XX,XXX
Profit: \$X,XXX
Margin: XX.X%
Orders: XXX

Top Category:
Technology

When the user hovers over a state, they get an analytical mini-report.

That is a very effective Tableau technique.

14. How to publish it publicly

This part is quite straightforward.

Create a free Tableau Public account.

Then, once your workbook is ready:

Server → Tableau Public → Save to Tableau Public

Sign into your Tableau Public account and save the workbook. Tableau creates an extract of your data when publishing to Tableau Public.  Tableau Help +1

Your visualization will then have a public webpage.

Very important

Tableau Public means **public**.

Anyone on the internet can access the published visualization, and Tableau notes that published workbooks/data can also be available for download.  Tableau Help +1

So:

Never put confidential company data into Tableau Public.

For private organizational data, Tableau Cloud/Server is the appropriate route instead.

 Tableau Help

15. How others can access your visualization

After publishing, your Tableau Public viz gets its own URL.

You can simply send that URL:

<https://public.tableau.com/...>

The person opens it in their browser and can interact with your dashboard.

Tableau also provides a **Share** option where you can obtain the link and embed code.

 Tableau Help +1

You can therefore put the viz on:

- LinkedIn
- GitHub README
- Personal portfolio website
- Resume/portfolio page
- Blog
- College project page

You can also embed the Tableau visualization into a webpage using the provided embed code.  Tableau Help

16. A very good portfolio structure

I would actually recommend creating **one complete project**, rather than ten small Tableau exercises.

For example:

Project

Global Superstore — Sales & Profitability Analysis

Business Questions

1. How are sales changing over time?
2. Which regions generate the most profit?
3. Which categories generate the most revenue?
4. Which products have high sales but low profit?
5. Does discounting affect profitability?
6. Which states are performing poorly?
7. Which customer segments are most valuable?

Dashboard

GLOBAL SUPERSTORE PERFORMANCE			
Sales	Profit	Orders	Profit Margin
Sales & Profit Trend			
Category Performance		Regional Performance	
Sales / Profit Map			
Filters: Year Region Category Segment			

Then make every major element interactive.

17. Your learning roadmap

I'd suggest this progression:

Week 1 — Tableau fundamentals

Learn:

- Dimensions vs Measures
- Rows/Columns
- Marks card
- Filters
- Aggregation
- Sorting
- Formatting
- Basic charts

Week 2 — Visual analytics

Learn:

- Color
- Size
- Shape
- Detail
- Tooltip
- Maps
- Scatter plots

- Heatmaps
- Calculated fields

Week 3 — Dashboard development

Learn:

- Dashboard layout
- Containers
- Filters
- Highlight actions
- Filter actions
- Parameters
- Navigation
- Tooltips

Week 4 — Portfolio project

Build:

Global Superstore Sales & Profitability Dashboard

Then publish it on Tableau Public.

The most important mindset

Don't ask:

"What chart can I make with this dataset?"

Ask:

"What question am I trying to answer?"

Then choose the visualization.

For example:

Question	Visualization
Which category sells most?	Bar chart
How are sales changing?	Line chart
Where are sales coming from?	Map
Is discount related to profit?	Scatter plot
Which products are problematic?	Scatter/highlight table

Question

What happens when I select a region?

Can the user choose Sales/Profit?

Visualization

Interactive dashboard

Parameter

That mindset will take you much further than simply learning Tableau's buttons.

One final recommendation

For your **first serious Tableau project**, I would use the Kaggle **Global Superstore** dataset and build **one polished interactive dashboard** rather than several small dashboards. It gives you enough dimensions to demonstrate **color, size, geographic analysis, calculated fields, filters, parameters, tooltips, dashboard actions and storytelling** all in one project. The dataset is also available as an Excel workbook, while Tableau Public supports Excel and CSV uploads directly. [k](#) Kaggle +1

If you want, I can next take you through this **Global Superstore project from absolute zero, step-by-step in Tableau Public** — including **exactly what to drag into Rows/Columns/Color/Size/Detail,** **which 6–8 sheets to create,** **calculated fields to write,** and **how to assemble the final interactive dashboard.**



ChatGPT can make mistakes. Check important info.